either mentioned or referred to his father and grandfather, his mother and maternal relations, as well as relations of his queens. He has not even cared anywhere to introduce himself as a scion of the Maurya family.' Barua (1946): 5.

10. Line 2, Jayaswal and Banerji (1933): 86.

11. Rock Edict 9 makes this evident. See Girnar version in Hultzsch (1925): 16.

12. *AS* 2.10.4, Kangle (1972): pt II, 92.

13. For a bibliography on the life of the Buddha, Nakamura (1989): 16–21. For a popular account of the life of the Buddha, Strong (2000).

14. Schober (1997): 4.

15. For the *Ashokavadana*, Strong (1989). While there may have been earlier literary versions of the story of Ashoka, this is chronologically the earliest text to have survived.

16. For Avadana literature, Winternitz (1933): vol. II, 277–94.

17. Schober (1997): x.

18. For this story, aptly called 'The Gift of Dirt', Strong (1989): 200–4.

19. This section, including the quotations, is based on Strong (1989): 198–204.

20. For a discussion of this 'inaccuracy', Strong (1989): 21–2.

21. See Moore (1921): 102.

22. In the *Ashokavadana*, Ashoka's mother is not named. For the various names of Ashoka's mother, Guruge (1993): 26–9.

23. Strong (1989): 204.

24. Chakrabarti (2001): 166–7; Sinha (2000): 22–5; and Prasad (2006). This was a city marked by burnt brick structures ranging from an earthen rampart revetted with burnt bricks to wells and drains.

25. The fair, good-looking, and gracious daughter who would become Bindusara's wife and Ashoka's mother is in the *Ashokavadana* mentioned as being the daughter of a Brahman from Champa. See Strong (1989): 204.

26. *AS* 1.17.18–19. Kangle (1972): pt II, 39–41.

27. Strong (1989): 204.

28. Ibid.

29. Ibid.

30. Ibid.